

My interest in startups began long before law school. During my sophomore year of college, after watching *The Social Network*, I became fascinated by the idea that a simple idea could grow into a transformative business. I spent countless hours brainstorming startup concepts with friends and roommates, pitching everything from social platforms to technology-enabled services. Most of those ideas never went anywhere, but the process sparked a lasting interest in entrepreneurship, innovation, and the people willing to take the risk of building something from nothing.

That interest followed me through law school, where I eventually launched a startup of my own and successfully secured federal trademark protection for its brand through an intent-to-use trademark application. Going through that process firsthand gave me an appreciation for the excitement, uncertainty, and optimism that accompany the earliest stages of a new venture.

Although I built my legal career in corporate law, I found myself most energized by the founders behind the businesses. I enjoyed learning about their ideas, understanding what they were trying to build, and helping them navigate the legal issues that stand between concept and execution. Over time, I realized that my greatest professional interest was not simply practicing law; it was helping founders bring their ideas to life.

At Venture Branding, that philosophy begins with trademarks. For many founders, selecting and protecting a brand is one of the first major legal milestones in the life of a company. It is also one of the most exciting. A trademark transforms an idea into something tangible: a name, a brand, and an identity that customers can recognize and trust. My goal is to help founders protect that identity while preserving the momentum and excitement that inspired them to start building in the first place.